The Cat's Bite

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Teen And Up Audiences

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Entrapta/Hordak (She-Ra), Catra & Hordak (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

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by DeltaFell

Summary

Hordak's been on Catra's ass for some time about attending one of his parties. Ever since Prime died, however, Catra has stayed as far away from organized vampire society as she could. The fewer reminders of Prime or her sire that she has to see, the better. Those bastards could get really vicious, and even all four of her friends can't protect her constantly. Unfortunately, she has to show up soon, or she'll weaken Hordak's position and open herself up to attack.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Catra rose to the sound of some asshole knocking on her door. Who the fuck was out this early, the sun was still up, for fuck's sake. She climbed out of the coffin - stereotypical, she knew, but it was pretty decent protection, especially after she lined it with titanium, making for far better than the thick curtains most of her kind favored these days.

She made her way slowly to the door as she racked her brain, trying to figure out who would be sending her an emissary this fucking early. Did they not learn after she ate the last two to come this early? It was probably one of the ancient ones trying to intimidate her by sending a lackey when they could be up. The whole "we can get to you when you think you're safe" schtick.

They'd actually be somewhat scary, if they had ever gotten new technology after the invention of the printing press. Apparently her sire had actually met Johanne Gutenberg, and thought he was a pompous prick. Her sire also thought that of anyone who didn't bend over and kiss her ass.

Catra opened the door, and to her surprise, didn't find an elder vampire, thrall or any manner of servant standing outside her door. Instead, she found a tall, blonde woman wearing a red suit jacket with absurdly stiff shoulders.

"Who the fuck are you?" said Catra.

"I'm Adora Grayskull, your ne-" she started.

"Who do you work for?" said Catra.

"Uh, you?" Adora laughed nervously.

Catra grabbed Adora by her suit jacket and hauled her inside. Catra extended her fangs.

"Who the fuck do you work for?"

"Are those fangs? Uh, shoot, I'm the new district rep, I was saying I work for you because I'm a public servant and I won by a landslide so odds were you voted for me. I thought it would be a kinda funny way to introduce myself and maybe get to know some of the people who I'm supposed to y'know, be in charge of?" Adora said. It sounded to Catra like she was saying it as fast as possible while remaining coherent.

"You've got to be shitting me. You don't know. Oh Hordak's not going to shut up about this for fucking decades," said Catra.

Adora paled. "You know Governor Dryl? Oh man I am so dead. I really needed to get on his good side and pissing you off won't help. What can I do to earn your forgiveness, please, there has to be something."

"Chillax Blondie, I'm not gonna bad mouth you to Hordak. You want to get into her good books? Come back here, say, six pm on Thursday, I'll explain things then. Now, I'm going back to my sleep, which you so rudely interrupted," said Catra, slamming her front door shut.

Catra could hear Adora's muffled worrying through the door. Once she was certain Adora had left, Catra said, "Dammit, why did I have to fucking flash my fangs at her. Now I've exposed the existence of vampires to an outsider. Well, taking her to the party at least solves that, sort of, and Hordak will get off my ass about coming. But if he finds out how this all happened, she'll flay me and Adora alive. Fuck."

At exactly six o'clock pm Thursday evening, there was a sharp rapping on her front door. Catra had been awake since five thirty, and going by her doorbell cam's feed, Adora had been there since five o'clock. Catra opened the door.

"You know you could've just knocked earlier? I probably would've woken up. Come on in, but leave the garlic outside, I can smell it on you. Leave any of the other dumb shit you thought might work outside, you've clearly guessed I'm a vampire, and I'll be taking you to a huge gathering of vampires, dhampires, thralls, and associated floozies," said Catra. "Having any of that stuff on you would not endear you to Hordak, trust me."

Adora, abashed, pulled out three vials of holy water, two packets of garlic, a jar of kosher salt, four wooden stakes, and a rowan

branch. She stashed all these items in one of the bushes nearby Catra's front porch. Catra had to admit, Adora was remarkably resourceful and inventive with her storage space. Adora straightened, and stepped into Catra's house.

Catra closed the door, and said, "Okay, so you've obviously figured out that I'm a vampire. Not everything you read in books is true, though. For one, there's a shit-ton of types of vampires, but you only really need to worry about three. You have your Eastern European vampires and you have your British Vampires, and dhampires. Eastern European vampires aren't necessarily accurate to what you see in something like Bram Stoker's Dracula. Stoker did a lot of research, which alerted the real Dracula, who went to confront Stoker. The two ended up quite close, but nobody really knows how close, as mentioning one to the other causes them to huff and pout dramatically."

"Wait, what?" said Adora.

"Dracula and Stoker are both massive drama queens, and don't you dare think of saying the word Dracula tonight, Stoker is supposed to be at the ball and that will be a massive coup for Hordak. Stoker hasn't been seen in public since he locked himself away after the Beatles broke up. Anyway, pop culture vampires are mostly British vampires, if they bear any resemblance to vampires whatsoever. British vampires typically need far more blood than Eastern European vampires, but are also way more powerful. Shape shifting, hypnosis, the whole works," said Catra.

"Okay, but what about the other two?" asked Adora.

"I'm getting there, jeez, Adora. Eastern European vampires have few of the weaknesses of British vampires, mostly garlic, mobs, and sunlight, although younger Eastern European vampires usually only get indigestion or at most hives from garlic. You haven't eaten any garlic lately have you?" said Catra.

Adora, beet red and focusing on the floor, shook her head.

"Hey, what's wrong?" asked Catra.

"It's just I was being really impatient and I'm sorry about that, you're being such a huge help to me and I really appreciate it," said Adora.

"Adora, I was joking around. You didn't do anything wrong, I just use humor to try and help break the ice but also form longer memories. Would you like me to dial back jokes like that?" said Catra.

Adora nodded.

"Okay, I won't make any jokes about your social conduct. Your limits deserve to be respected, Adora, if I say something that makes you uncomfortable, you have to tell me. Same with at the party. Nobody's going to mock you or take offense at being expected to respect your boundaries. Hordak's pretty good about that. He once kicked out Richard Nixon and Henry Kissinger (also

vampires, by the way) for intentionally deadnaming her wife's sister."

Adora smiled slightly and looked up at Catra.

"What about dhampires?" she said.

Catra said, "Dhampire is basically the word for a half vampire. Dhampires often possess most of the abilities of their vampiric parent, but without the weaknesses. Most dhampires can live relatively normal lives, so you probably won't see many tonight."

"Speaking of, just what have I agreed to, exactly?" said Adora.

"Going as my date to Hordak's Annual Ball. He's been trying to get me to go for fucking ages, and going with you will get her off my ass and get you a good chance to talk with him. Hell, being able to get me to go in the first place will probably get you pretty damn high up in her eyes," said Catra.

"Why don't you usually go?" Adora said.

"So, vampires have districts, like humans do, only ours tend to cover more area, because there's way fewer of us. Hordak's sire, Prime, was the previous district count, which is basically like a governor. Prime was a creepy motherfucker and by the time Hordak and I came around, absolutely bat-shit insane," said Catra.

“Prime did his damnedest to control me, and because of that and my sire's bullshit, I tend to stay away from most organized anythings, really. When Prime was killed by a group of vampire hunters, Hordak inherited the position, and as basically his only ally, she did everything he could to make me more comfortable with vampire society."

"So why don't you just go with her then? If you're his only ally, it's not like Hordak has anyone else to go with," said Adora.

"Hordak goes with her wife. I used to be his only ally, but she's found some others. And no, I can't go with them, because they're all married, and going with someone else's spouse or spouses is a huge taboo. And without someone I'm going with, I don't really feel comfortable going at all."

"Yeah, that makes sense, I'm the same way," Adora said.

"Okay, if we want to avoid suspicion - because I am a notable recluse - we should probably pretend that we're dating. Me showing up with a friend I've never mentioned before will seem off to Hordak, but showing up with a significant other I've never mentioned before will make sense, because it would seem like I was uncomfortable presenting any kind of potential leverage on me until I'm absolutely ready. Wait, are you a lesbian?" said Catra.

Adora laughed, "Yes, I am a lesbian. I'd be comfortable pretending to be your girlfriend, although I feel like I should warn you, I don't know how dating normal people works, let alone dating a vampire."

"Okay, well it's mostly the same as dating a normal person, but with two big differences. For one, you're probably awake mostly at night, and for the second, there's the bite. This is a Eastern European vampire thing, since British vampires often completely drain anyone they bite," said Catra.

"Well that's, uh, concerning. You're not a British vampire, are you?" said Adora.

"No, I'm of the Eastern European variety. I'm not going to do it without your consent, because that would be all kinds of fucked up, and you don't have to. The bite is usually on the side of the neck or the lower jaw, and is like halfway between dating and an engagement ring. It's an 'I am theirs and they are mine' type of thing. It's not uncommon to not announce a significant other until this point has been reached, which will help sell the story," said Catra.

"Does it give you any kind of control over me? I've heard that's a thing vampires can do to people they've bitten," said Adora.

"That's mostly an Iberian vampire thing, but that kind of control requires a vampire to actually take some of your blood, and this bite is traditionally one that does not draw blood. We can worry about that one after we find you something to wear," said Catra, turning towards her closet.

“So, do I wear that white dress from earlier, or do I wear this?” Adora stepped out from the guest room. She was wearing a sleeveless two-toned red dress open along the sides and much of the back, with a golden belt around her waist. Adora had her hair in a bun with two hair sticks holding it in place.

“Definitely this one. I like this one much more. Besides if anything goes wrong, the blood won’t be very visible on it,” Catra said.

At Adora’s pale expression, Catra added, “That was a joke, I don’t think anything that drastic could happen. I’ll get changed, give you the bite, and we’ll be off.”

Catra walked into her bedroom, and perused her closet. She had a surprising amount of formal wear, for someone as reclusive as her. Catra had a maroon suit jacket with matching pants and a burgundy shirt, or a white and gold v-neck dress. Catra thought the suit would match better with Adora’s dress, and so she pulled it on.

Catra was rewarded with the naked look of shock on Adora’s face when she saw her in the suit.

“You, uh, you look good,” she said.

“Judging from the look on your face, I look more than good,” said Catra.

“Okay,” Adora exhaled as if to psych herself up, “I’m ready for that bite now. Might as well get it over with.”

Catra nodded, and leaned into Adora. Her mouth next to Adora’s neck, Catra found an area without blood vessels, and bit down gently. After a few seconds of contact, Catra backed up and surveyed the bite mark. It would pretty clearly communicate to any vampires or vampire-adjacents that Adora was taken. That would be more than enough to protect Adora, even if she was separated from Catra.

Catra stood outside Hordak’s mansion, preparing to walk in with Adora. It took more effort to actually walk in than she had expected. Last time she had really been here, it was still Prime’s mansion. Adora looked aside at her, but before she could say anything, Catra threw open the doors and walked in.

As she had expected, the entire hall fell silent at her bombastic entry, and stayed silent when they realized who had just showed up. Catra scanned the crowd, looking for a shock of white hair, blue hair, or long purple pigtails. Entrapta and Hordak were, as usual, quite visible in the crowd, Hordak’s tall stature and Entrapta’s signature hair giving their location dead away.

Catra dragged Adora over to their position right away, hoping to get Adora to Hordak before the stresses of hosting the party ruined her mood.

“Hey Hordak, ‘Trapta, this is my girlfriend Adora, Adora, these are my friends Hordak and Entrapta Dryl,” Catra said.

Adora held out her hand, “Hi, Governor Dryl, Dr. Dryl, it’s nice to finally meet you. I’m Adora Greyskull, Catra’s girlfriend.”

“It’s nice to meet you, Representative Greyskull. I’d been meaning to have my office get in touch with yours for some time now, it is quite fortuitous that you’re here now. I took notice of many of your proposed policies during your election run. Leaving business aside, I’m glad to see Catra has someone else important to her now. We’ve been concerned for her since her last visit with Prime before his death. She grew exceptionally reclusive, even for her, and it's good to see her making more connections now,” Hordak said.

“Hello, Adora! Are you enjoying participating in this social experiment? I’m particularly fascinated by how Catra’s appearance with you on her arm will impact the way social bonds are formed and broken tonight. I wonder how The Weaver’s minions will react to this news. She herself certainly would not respond well,” said Entrapta.

“Sharon’s minions are here? And you didn’t fucking warn me?” said Catra.

“Well for one we didn’t think you’d actually show up, and we can actually hurt her reputation and influence by inviting her minions but not her more than we can if we just totally snubbed her. If you’d told us you were at least coming, we could have warned

you, but you chose the fucking drama queen option, all the way down to flinging the doors open," said Hordak.

"Don't you call me a drama queen, you have Bram fucking Stoker here -" Catra was cut off as the doors to Hordak's mansion flew off their hinges. In the doorway stood a tall figure in a deep red dress, with long black hair and a red mask covering her face.

"Sharon?" asked Catra.

At the same time, Adora said "Mother?"

"Catra, how lovely to see you again. I do hope you've grown out of this rebellious phase of yours and decided to come home," said Shadow Weaver.

"Catra, how do you know her?" said Adora.

"She's my sire, unfortunately. She and I split a ways back. I hate the pompous, self-serving bitch," said Catra.

"Good. My foster mother's a fucking narcissistic prick," said Adora.

"Mother, stay the hell away from my girlfriend." Adora stepped out in front of Catra. Adora had on a golden bracelet she hadn't been

wearing previously.

“Girlfriend? Stop this foolishness at once Adora, and come home with me,” said Shadow Weaver as she stepped forward.

“I warned you,” said Adora, touching a hand to the bracelet as it started to glow.

“For the honor of Grayskull!” she shouted, filling the room with bright light.

Adora was now much taller, and dressed in white and gold armor. She held in her hands a large sword.

“Adora, did you get your last name from your fucking magical girl sword?” said Catra.

“Maybe,” said Adora.

“Bah, foolish girl, you cannot hope to stand up to me,” said Shadow Weaver.

“Are you sure about that? I am she who has slain Prime. You are naught but a gnat before me," Adora said. "Prepare to die, monster!"

And with a yell, Adora leapt towards Shadow Weaver. Shadow Weaver's minions turned on the party guests, and Catra, Entrapta and Hordak quickly found themselves surrounded. Catra grinned. Finally, a good fight. It'd been far too long since she got to kick some ass.

End Notes

I'm back! Sort of! I wrote this like all the last three days, mostly on the bus home. It's still Friday here by like a minute I'm in time! I don't have any more in this universe planned, and although I don't have anything else close to posting right now, I do want to put something together before December. We'll see on that though lmao, my major is rough (we did figure out the components, for anyone wondering). I've been watching FMAB, so I might get some ideas from that, who knows.

I can't even tell y'all what works influenced this, aside from all the ones I read that had vampires in it. Which is a lot ngl. Probably mostly Dresden Files and D&D and SPOP fanfic tbh - but not n7punk's recent one. I only started reading that after I wrote this.

Thanks for reading, you sustain me. It's always a pleasure to wake up to new comments/kudos/hits.

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